

YASASVINI MANICHANDRIKA AKANA

+1 (864) 435 6917 | akanaymc@gmail.com| <https://www.linkedin.com/in/aymanichandrika/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Analytical and results-driven Business Analyst with a strong background in transforming complex datasets into actionable insights that drive strategic growth and operational efficiency. Proficient in SQL, Python, Power BI, Tableau, and Advanced Excel, with expertise in data modeling, predictive analytics, and performance measurement. Adept at identifying process gaps, designing scalable analytical solutions, and delivering data-backed recommendations that improve key business KPIs. Experienced in applying Agile and Scrum methodologies to manage cross-functional initiatives and ensure timely, high-quality deliverables. Skilled in requirements gathering, stakeholder management, and business process improvement, fostering alignment between technical teams and business goals. Known for strong data storytelling and visualization abilities that enable better decision-making across diverse organizational levels. Passionate about leveraging AI/ML, automation, and data-driven strategies to optimize performance and enhance overall business value.

SKILLS

Data Management & Analytics: SQL, Python, Power BI, Tableau, Advanced Excel, Data Modeling, Data Warehousing, Data Transformation, ETL Pipelines, KPI & Trend Analysis, Dashboard Development, A/B Testing Analytics

Business & Product Analysis: Requirements Gathering, Business Process Optimization, User Journey Mapping, Customer Segmentation, Product Performance Analysis, Pricing & Promotion Analytics, Forecasting & Demand Planning

E-commerce & Marketing Analytics Tools: Google Analytics (GA4), Shopify Analytics, Salesforce CRM, Adobe Analytics, Campaign Tracking, Conversion Funnel Optimization, CLV & Retention Analysis, Marketing ROI Measurement

Reporting & Visualization: Data Storytelling, Visualization Frameworks, Real-Time Dashboard Creation, Performance Reporting, Executive Insights, Cross-Channel KPI Tracking

Project Management & Methodologies: Agile / Scrum, Sprint Planning, Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, Stakeholder Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Post-Implementation Support

Core Competencies: Analytical Thinking, Problem Solving, Business Insight, Strategic Decision-Making, Collaboration, Continuous Improvement, Communication & Stakeholder Engagement

WORK EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant

Aug 2024 - May 2025

University of South Carolina, Upstate – SC, USA

- Partnered with university leadership and 15+ international stakeholders to design and deliver analytics-driven engagement programs, resulting in a 40% increase in participation and establishment of three long-term strategic partnerships.
- Collected and analysed multi-source datasets (event data, participant records, survey results) using SQL and Python to extract insights on engagement trends, satisfaction drivers, and operational gaps.
- Designed and deployed a Power BI-based event management dashboard integrating real-time attendance, registration, and feedback metrics—reducing administrative overhead by 30% and improving decision visibility.

- Developed and automated reporting workflows that reduced manual reporting time by 20%, improving data accuracy and transparency for faculty-led research initiatives.
- Applied Agile methodologies for project tracking, sprint planning, and stakeholder reviews to ensure timely and iterative delivery of data solutions.
- Presented analytical findings to cross-functional teams through visual storytelling, supporting data-driven decisions in event management and stakeholder relations.

Business Analyst

May 2022 - Dec 2023

Amazon – Hyderabad, India

- Analyzed performance metrics across 1,500+ B2B clients using SQL, Excel, and Power BI to identify behavioral trends, sales drivers, and retention opportunities—improving client retention by 35%.
- Partnered with operations, finance, and product management teams to assess customer acquisition, order fulfillment efficiency, and product category performance, leading to \$150K in annual operational cost savings.
- Designed and implemented automated Power BI dashboards providing real-time KPIs on account performance, sales revenue, and response time—reducing manual reporting by 60% and enhancing leadership visibility.
- Conducted root cause and variance analysis to monitor key e-commerce metrics such as conversion rate, order frequency, and customer churn, driving actionable recommendations for process improvement.
- Collaborated with product owners to translate business requirements into scalable data models and analytics solutions, ensuring alignment with business goals.
- Facilitated stakeholder meetings, defined KPIs, and prepared business requirement documents (BRDs) for analytics initiatives.
- Mentored and trained 20+ new analysts trained in SQL querying, dashboard development, and performance analytics, improving onboarding speed and analytical accuracy by 40%.

Business Analyst - Apprenticeship

Nov 2021 - Apr 2022

Turing Minds.AI – Hyderabad, India

- Conducted exploratory data analysis (EDA) on 2M+ customer records to uncover behavioral and transactional trends that increased marketing campaign conversions by 15%.
- Built and optimized predictive models in Python (Scikit-learn) for customer churn and retention prediction, resulting in 30% higher retention and over \$500K in projected lifetime value gains.
- Designed and implemented Power BI dashboards to monitor customer lifecycle KPIs, sales pipeline performance, and campaign ROI, enabling data-driven leadership decisions.
- Enhanced machine learning model performance by 20% through advanced feature engineering, hyperparameter tuning, and validation methods.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to define business requirements and data flows, ensuring all analytical processes adhered to Agile documentation and compliance standards.
- Supported A/B testing and post-campaign performance analysis to identify the most effective retention and engagement strategies.

Business Analyst - Internship
Navcara Private Limited – Remote, India

May 2021 - Oct 2021

- Partnered with a team of five data scientists to preprocess and analyze 150+ large-scale datasets, improving model precision by 40% and reducing analytical turnaround time by 30%.
- Conducted requirements gathering with business teams to define KPIs, success metrics, and performance indicators for new analytics initiatives.
- Developed interactive dashboards in Tableau and Power BI that visualized customer trends, sales growth, and operational KPIs—enhancing executive engagement by 60% during review meetings.
- Utilized Python and R for statistical forecasting, regression, and correlation analysis to identify trends impacting sales and customer satisfaction.
- Authored comprehensive documentation of analytical findings, workflows, and recommendations to ensure repeatability and cross-team knowledge sharing.
- Collaborated closely with senior analysts to improve reporting accuracy and introduce data validation techniques, reducing errors in monthly performance reports by 25%.

PROJECTS

Capstone Project – Rethink Food: Event Strategy & Analytics
University of South Carolina, Upstate – Spartanburg, SC

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Partnered with Rethink Food, a New York-based nonprofit serving over 40,000 meals weekly, to analyze fundraising performance, event ROI, and donor engagement trends.
- Consolidated and analyzed multi-source data from QuickBooks, Salesforce, Classy, and social media to evaluate event profitability, repeat participation, and engagement metrics.
- Designed interactive Power BI dashboards and profitability models to visualize fundraising outcomes, participation growth, and campaign effectiveness.
- Conducted benchmarking and market analysis across U.S. event spaces to inform strategic event pricing and marketing optimization.
- Delivered data-driven recommendations projected to increase ROI by 20% and improve donor retention through targeted engagement initiatives.
- Applied SQL and Python-based data cleaning, transformation, and KPI modeling to streamline reporting workflows for leadership presentations.

Capstone Project – Fathers and Families Predictive Analytics
University of South Carolina, Upstate – Spartanburg, SC

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Collaborated with the South Carolina Center for Fathers and Families (SCCFF) to analyze program outcomes and participant success metrics for over 5,000+ individuals across 15 sites.
- Utilized Python (Pandas, Scikit-learn) to develop predictive models that identified high-risk program dropouts, enabling early intervention and resource allocation.
- Performed statistical analysis and regression modeling to measure skill improvement, employability impact, and program completion rates.
- Designed interactive Power BI dashboards and Sankey diagrams to illustrate participant progression, retention, and engagement pathways.
- Delivered actionable insights that improved intervention efficiency by 25%, directly influencing program design and impact assessment.

- Partnered with leadership to translate analytical findings into policy recommendations and program optimization plans.

Cross-Cultural Engagement Analysis Using NLP
University of South Carolina – Spartanburg, SC

Aug 2024 – May 2025

- Conducted natural language processing (NLP) analysis on over 1 million social media interactions to uncover engagement sentiment and cultural tone variations across regions.
- Leveraged Python (NLTK, spaCy) and sentiment analysis techniques to quantify emotional polarity and identify key audience segments.
- Enhanced predictive accuracy of NLP models by 25% through feature optimization, tokenization improvements, and algorithm tuning.
- Built Power BI dashboards and text visualizations to summarize linguistic insights for non-technical stakeholders.
- Delivered data-driven communication strategies that improved engagement outcomes by 40% across international campaigns.
- Ensured full data governance and stakeholder alignment throughout the analysis lifecycle, adhering to ethical data handling standards.

EDUCATION

- **University of South Carolina, Upstate - Spartanburg, South Carolina**
Master of Science, Business Analytics - GPA - 3.8
- **St. Ann's Degree College for Women, Mallapur – Hyderabad, India**
Bachelor of Science, Statistics- GPA - 3.9